Bereket Tilahun

Backend Security Engineer · Addis Ababa, Ethiopia (UTC+3)

Open to remote backend and application-security roles. I also take fixed-price security reviews of Supabase, Next.js and Stripe apps.

berekettilahun77@gmail.com · linkedin.com/in/berekettilahun · github.com/Berakhah · berakhah.github.io

Experience

Senior Software Engineer May 2026 – Present

DZ Software Engineering PLC · Addis Ababa

Promoted in May 2026; part-time since August 2026.

Software Engineer Jul 2023 – Apr 2026

DZ Software Engineering PLC · Addis Ababa

- Hardened 47 API endpoints (schema validation, parameterized queries, rate limiting, Bandit/pip-audit pre-merge gates) and closed 9 High/Critical findings from internal reviews and dependency scans.
- Moved services one at a time from long-lived shared secrets to Keycloak, replacing 11 long-lived secrets with 5-minute, audience-scoped tokens issued by token exchange.
- Made Trivy image scans a hard deploy gate and built an append-only audit pipeline; incident reconstruction takes under 20 minutes.
- On a 15-service FastAPI and Django REST platform, added Redis caching that cut p95 latency from 340 ms to 195 ms.
- Built an LLM evaluation pipeline and CI gate that scores code submissions on correctness, reliability and runtime; it runs on 11 production services and cut manual review time by 40%.
- Built a benchmark-curation pipeline over PostgreSQL telemetry and Redis event streams that produced 1,200+ labeled records and cut mean time to detect model-quality regressions by 30%.
- Deployed evaluation services on AWS (EC2, S3, role-scoped IAM, VPC isolation) across 11 staging/production pairs; rollback time fell 35%.

Full Stack Developer Mar 2022 – Jun 2023

DZ Software Engineering PLC · Addis Ababa

- Triaged 10–12 Tier-1 incidents a day across Python, Java and C++ services; wrote runbooks and automated health checks that cut recurring failures by 15%.
- Scanned 10+ production Linux hosts with OpenSCAP and fixed 23 misconfigurations, including credential backup files readable by every user.
- Set observability baselines (Prometheus/Grafana, ELK, Zabbix) later adopted in 3 production environments.

Freelance Backend Engineer (part-time) Mar 2021 – Jun 2023

Independent, for small organizations · Remote

- Built backends on FastAPI, Django REST and Spring Boot, with React/Node.js frontends.

Projects (personal, 2026, public on GitHub)

- **ShopFast sample audit** (demo, not client work): a Next.js + Supabase + Stripe store with 8 planted flaws; 6 are re-proven by one command (`npm run poc`).
- **Agent Perimeter** (Apache-2.0): security scanner for MCP servers and AI agents, 34 checks in 8 groups, 940 Python test functions; enumerated all 31,953 MCP Registry entries and analysed a 377-artifact sample.
- **Ledger Sense self-audit**: audited my own invoice pipeline and recorded 34 findings (1 Critical, 15 High, 18 Medium); reproduced and fixed the Critical, a cross-tenant export deletion.

Skills

Security	OWASP Top 10 · PostgreSQL row-level security · Keycloak / OIDC token exchange · Bandit · pip-audit · Trivy · OpenSCAP
Backend	Python · FastAPI · Django REST · Spring Boot · PostgreSQL · Redis · SQLAlchemy + Alembic · TypeScript · Next.js
Infrastructure	Docker & Compose · GitHub Actions · AWS (EC2, S3, IAM, VPC) · Linux · Prometheus / Grafana · ELK · Zabbix

Education

B.Sc. Computer Science — HiLCoE School of Computer Science & Technology, Addis Ababa Jan 2021 – Jul 2026